Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, September 15, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Moring
		N. Henry
		S. Lee

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of June 23, 2025;
- Closed Meeting of June 23, 2025;
- Special Meeting of July 29, 2025;
- Closed Meeting of July 29, 2025;
- Special Meeting of August 15, 2025; and
- Closed Meeting of August 15, 2025.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Item 7.2 General Government Committee September 8, 2025 (Report PDS-2025-21)

Heather Middleton, Ajax Resident, delivered a delegation related to agenda item 7.2 General Government Committee, September 8, 2025 (Report PDS-2025-21).

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. H. Middleton responded to questions from Council Members.

6. Correspondence

6.1 Ajax Pickering Road Watch – Support for an All-Way Stop Installation at Seggar Avenue and Williamson Drive

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That Item 6.1 (“Ajax Pickering Road Watch – Support for an All-Way Stop Installation at Seggar Avenue and Williamson Drive”) be referred to Item 9.4 (“3-Way Stop Installation at Williamson Drive West & Seggar Avenue”).

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

6.2 Nottingham Public School – Letter of Support – Road Safety Measures at Seggar Avenue and Williams Road

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That 6.2 (“Nottingham Public School – Letter of Support – Road Safety Measures at Seggar Avenue and Williams Road”) be referred to Item 9.4 (“3-Way Stop Installation at Williamson Drive West & Seggar Avenue”).

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

6.3 Petition in Relation to a 3-Way Stop Sign at Selby Drive and Searell Avenue, Ajax

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That Item 6.3 (“Petition in Relation to a 3-Way Stop Sign at Selby Drive and Searell Avenue, Ajax”) be referred to Item 9.3 (“3-Way Stop Installation at Searell Avenue & Selby Drive”).

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, September 2, 2025

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated September 2, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, September 8, 2025

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated September 8, 2025, be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3 Departmental Reports

7.3.1 Update on Homelessness in Ajax
(Referred from September 8, 2025 General Government Committee)

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

1. That Staff be directed to coordinate a public town hall meeting for residents and businesses about the impacts of homelessness in Ajax with the appropriate staff from the Region of Durham and Durham Regional Police Services; and

2. That this meeting be held after Staff have introduced the Crisis Care Facility By-law at the October 2025 meeting of Council.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3.2 OES-2025-23: Contract Award – Porte Road Improvements

Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Council Award the Contract for Porte Road Improvements, to Wyndale Paving Co. Ltd. in the amount of $237,875.03 (inclusive of all taxes).

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to Durham Regional Police Service Board – Quarterly Update to Council.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of September 15, 2025 be received for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Temporary Removal of Harwood Avenue North from Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) Rotation

Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. G. Romanowski and Dhaval Pandya, Manager of Transportation Planning, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

Whereas, the speed limit along Harwood Avenue North, between Rossland Road and Williamson Drive, has been temporarily reduced to 40 km/h to accommodate ongoing construction projects in the area (Grandview Headquarters and Schlegel Villages);

Whereas, this same section of roadway is currently included in the Town's Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) rotation;

Whereas, the temporary speed limit and ongoing construction may compromise effectiveness of ASE operations;

Whereas, in June 2025, report CS-2025-12 delegated authority to staff to undertake the following activities, among others:

- Expand the current Administrative Monetary Penalties System (AMPS) to include ASE offences (Phase III), with a targeted commencement date in Q3 2025;
- Approve future ASE camera installation locations within designated Community Safety Zones (CSZs), including the addition, relocation, and adjustment of cameras, as well as the approval of their operational hours and enforcement thresholds;

Therefore be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council directs the temporary removal of Harwood Avenue North from the ASE rotation until construction in the area is deemed complete and the roadway and impacted intersection are fully operational.

2. That staff be directed to investigate the feasibility of restoring the speed limit on the subject section of Harwood Avenue North to 50 km/h, and provide an update to the public.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies

CARRIED

9.2 **Supporting Healthy Democracy Through the Elect Respect Campaign**

Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: N. Henry

Whereas, Democracy is healthy when everyone can participate fully and safely and contribute to the well-being of their community; and

Whereas, we are witnessing the dissolution of democratic discourse and respectful debate across all levels of government and in neighbouring jurisdictions; and

Whereas, Ontario's municipally elected officials are dealing with increasingly hostile, unsafe work environments, facing threats and harassment; and

Whereas, social media platforms have exacerbated disrespectful dialogue, negative commentary, and toxic engagement, which disincentivizes individuals, especially women and candidates from diverse backgrounds, from running for office; and

Whereas, better decisions are made when democracy is respectful and constructive, and the voices of diverse genders, identities, ethnicities, races, sexual orientations, ages, and abilities are heard and represented around municipal council tables; and

Whereas, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario's Healthy Democracy Project has identified concerning trends with fewer people voting in local elections and running for municipal office; and

Whereas, in 2024, female elected representatives from Halton formed H.E.R. (Halton Elected Representatives) to speak out against harassment in politics and uphold high standards of conduct, launching the Elect Respect campaign to promote healthy democracy and safe, inclusive work environments by encouraging respectful discourse, condemning abuse, and empowering diverse participation in public office; and

Whereas, on June 5, 2025, the Canadian Association of Feminist Parliamentarians launched a non-partisan "Parliamentary Civility Pledge" to encourage all parliamentarians to commit to end workplace harassment and increase civility on Parliament Hill, modelled after the pledge developed in Halton by representatives of H.E.R.

Therefore be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council supports the *Elect Respect* pledge and commits to:

    - Treat others with respect in all spaces—public, private, and online,

    - Reject and call out harassment, abuse, and personal attacks,

    - Focus debate on ideas and policies, not personal attacks,

- Help build a supportive culture where people of all backgrounds feel safe to run for and hold office,

- Call on relevant authorities to ensure the protection of elected officials who face abuse or threats, and

- Model integrity and respect by holding one another to the highest standards of conduct; and

2. That Ajax Council encourages elected officials, organizations, and community members to support the *Elect Respect* campaign and sign the online pledge at www.electrespect.ca; and

3. That a copy of this motion be sent to the Honourable Rob Flack, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing, Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax, Lorne Coe, MPP for Whitby, John Henry, Chair of the Regional Municipality of Durham, the Regional Municipality of Durham, all Durham Region lower-tier municipalities, and the Ontario Big City Mayors.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9.3 **3-Way Stop Installation at Searell Avenue & Selby Drive**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. D. Pandya responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

Whereas, the intersection of Searell Avenue and Selby Drive is adjacent to Meadows Park and Vimy Ridge Public School;

Whereas, children and families on the west side of Searell must either jay-walk or walk to the intersection of Searell Avenue and Telford Street to cross at a stop sign;

Whereas, there is a 3-Way Stop sign on the east side of Meadows Park and Vimy Ridge Public School at Bellinger Drive and Taverner Crescent;

Whereas, the community could be well served by the addition of a 3-way stop installation, allowing families to safely cross Searell Avenue to access the park and school;

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council approves the installation of a 3-Way Stop at the intersection of Searell Ave. & Selby Dr. by the end of October 2025.

2. That the cost to install the stop signs be managed within the 2025 Operations and Environmental Services budget in accordance with the Operating Budget Management Policy.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the motion, along with Item 6.3 (“Petition in Relation to a 3-Way Stop Sign at Selby

Drive and Searell Avenue, Ajax") be referred to the 2026 Mayor's budget process.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry

CARRIED

9.4 **3-Way Stop Installation at Williamson Drive West & Seggar Avenue**

Councillor Henry and Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Lee

Whereas, a crossing upgrade has been recommended for the intersection of Williamson Drive West and Seggar Avenue in the 2026 Capital Budget, including a higher-order pedestrian crossover (PXO);

Whereas, community members and organizations, including families, Road Watch, and the administration of Nottingham Public School, have shared that they feel they would be better served by a 3-way stop installation;

Whereas, stop signs are cheaper, require less maintenance, and ensure drivers come to a complete stop;

Therefore be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council approves the installation of a 3-Way Stop at the intersection of Williamson Dr. W. and Seggar Ave. by the end of October 2025.

2. That the cost to install the stop signs be managed within the 2025 Operations and Environmental Services budget in accordance with the Operating Budget Management Policy.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the motion, along with Item 6.1 ("Ajax Pickering Road Watch – Support for an All-Way Stop Installation at Seggar Avenue and Williamson Drive") and Item 6.2 ("Nottingham Public School – Letter of Support – Road Safety Measures at Seggar Avenue and Williams Road ") be referred to the 2026 Mayor's budget process.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law numbers 67-2025 to 73-2025 be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee provided notice that he will be bringing forward a motion to the October meeting of Council related to the Mental Health and Addictions Urgent Care and Emergency Department in Oshawa.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law number 74-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on September 15, 2025, be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the September 15, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (2:31 p.m.)

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk